



Borussia Dortmund also faltered, throwing away a two-goal lead against St Pauli after the 85th minute. The Black and Yellow had led 3-1 through Serhou Guirassy, Waldemar Anton and Julian Brandt, while Andréas Hountondji got one back for the home side. However, with just five minutes of regulation time left, Filippo Mane was shown a straight red card for a foul inside the box, which was converted by Danel Sinani. St Pauli then completed a dramatic turnaround in the 89th minute with Eric Smith firing home from outside the box.

Serie A

Napoli did not appear to miss its injured striker, Romelu Lukaku, as it began its title defence with a 2-0 victory over promoted Sassuolo. Last season's Most Valuable Player, Scott McTominay, showed no signs of slowing down as he headed in the club's first goal of the league season. His former Manchester rival and league debutant, Kevin De Bruyne,

then doubled the tally with a free-kick that bounced in untouched.

Veteran midfielder Luka Modric, meanwhile, had a contrasting start to his AC Milan career as his side fell to a shock 1-2 home defeat against newly-promoted Cremonese. The visitor took the lead through Federico Baschirotto, which was cancelled out just before half-time by Strahinja Pavlovic.

Cremonese restored its advantage just after the hour, with Federico Bonazzoli producing a stunning overhead kick to seal only its second-ever Serie A victory at San Siro. Record-winner Juventus began on a positive note with a tidy 2-0 win over Parma, secured by goals from debutant Jonathan David and Dusan Vlahovic.

Ligue 1

Despite being overwhelming favourites, Paris Saint-Germain began its campaign with scrappy wins in its first two matches.

A deflected strike from Vitinha

On the prowl: LOSC Lille's Olivier Giroud became the club's oldest league scorer with a goal against Brest. *AFP*

was enough to edge past Nantes in an otherwise dull fixture. In the following game against Angers, Ballon d'Or front runner Ousmane Dembele skied a penalty before Fabian Ruiz spared his blushes with a close-range finish.

Meanwhile, Olivier Giroud is enjoying his return to Ligue 1 from Major League Soccer, scoring in both of LOSC Lille's matches so far. The 38-year-old became the club's oldest league scorer during a 3-3 draw with Brest, before bagging a stoppage-time winner against Monaco.

Four teams — Lyon, Toulouse FC, PSG and RC Strasbourg — share the lead on six points from two games, with Lyon leading the pack on goal difference.

(All results updated as of August 24)